which have generated encouraging customer response, especially in the EV segment. Our electric vehicles, MG Comet and MG ZS EV, continue to gain attention.

● **PAWAH:** With the right timing between a major product offensive, financial offers and the festive season, BMW Group India is capitalising very well on the demand in luxury segment. In the time preceding the festive season, we launched nine powerful products—both cars and motorcycles—and we will keep this momentum going. With BMW 360° finance plan, flexible and comprehensive packages have been crafted to suit individual needs.

● **IYER:** We expect a strong festive season and we should be growing in double digits compared to last year. We have exciting products like the New E-Class planned for festive launch. In addition, we have new world-class BEVs, like the EQS Maybach and the EQS SUV 580 launched recently, which are driving the BEV sales at top-end.

● **BANERJEE:** The festive season has always been a pivotal period for the automotive industry, often accounting for about a quarter of annual sales. This year, Maruti Suzuki is stepping into this joyous time with remarkable momentum, having achieved record-breaking sales in Q1—our best and a milestone for the Indian automotive sector as a whole. Our optimism is bolstered by supportive government policies and encouraging macroeconomic indicators. But because of a high base year in 2023, we anticipate a more moderate growth trajectory.

SATINDER SINGH BAJWA
Chief Commercial Officer, JSW MG Motor India

SANTOSH IYER
MD & CEO, Mercedes-Benz India





Q. WHAT ROLE DO YOU EXPECT EVs TO PLAY AS FAR AS SALES ARE CONCERNED THIS YEAR?

● **BAJWA:** We are confident that the recent launch of the India's first intelligent CUV—MG Windsor, our third electric vehicle—will further boost sales momentum. And, with our recently announced industry-first initiative BaaS, we have created a platform for easy ownership, making our EVs more accessible than ever. Given the strong response to the BaaS programme offered on Windsor, we have also extended its benefits to our popular EV models, the Comet and ZS.

● **PAWAH:** The Indian electric luxury market is still at a nascent stage but has immense potential. With continued support from the government, widespread availability of products across different segments and a strong charging infrastructure, electric mobility adoption will increase significantly. BMW Group India now offers six electric cars and two electric scooters in India. It is the first luxury car manufacturer in the country to cross the milestone of over 2,000 EV deliveries to date.

● **IYER:** Our Battery EVs are growing at 60 per cent. We have doubled our BEV penetration to 5 per cent in the first half of 2024 and we expect the segment to continuously grow, albeit it will still take some time to achieve significant volumes. We already have a strong portfolio of six BEVs in India, from the EQA to the range-topping, ultra-luxurious EQS Maybach SUV, thus offering a BEV for every customer preference and requirement.

Q. WHAT ROLE DO YOU EXPECT HYBRIDS TO PLAY...

● **BANERJEE:** In the evolving landscape of Indian automotive preferences, strong hybrids are steadily capturing the spotlight. As consumers become more informed about the technology, it's clear that hybrids are carving out their niche. For Maruti Suzuki, strong hybrid models saw a surge in demand the last fiscal. What sets them apart is the incorporation of regenerative braking technology, a game-changer. By 2030, we expect 25 per cent of our sales to come from hybrid models.